Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Four AC treatments (doxorubicin 60 mg/m² and cyclophosphamide 600 mg/m²) 14 days apart, followed 14 days after the last AC by 12 weekly paclitaxel 80 mg/m² doses, subject to recovery. The planned sequence spans about 20 weeks.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy

Hair loss or thinning varies; ask about support.

2 Mouth

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

3 Breathing

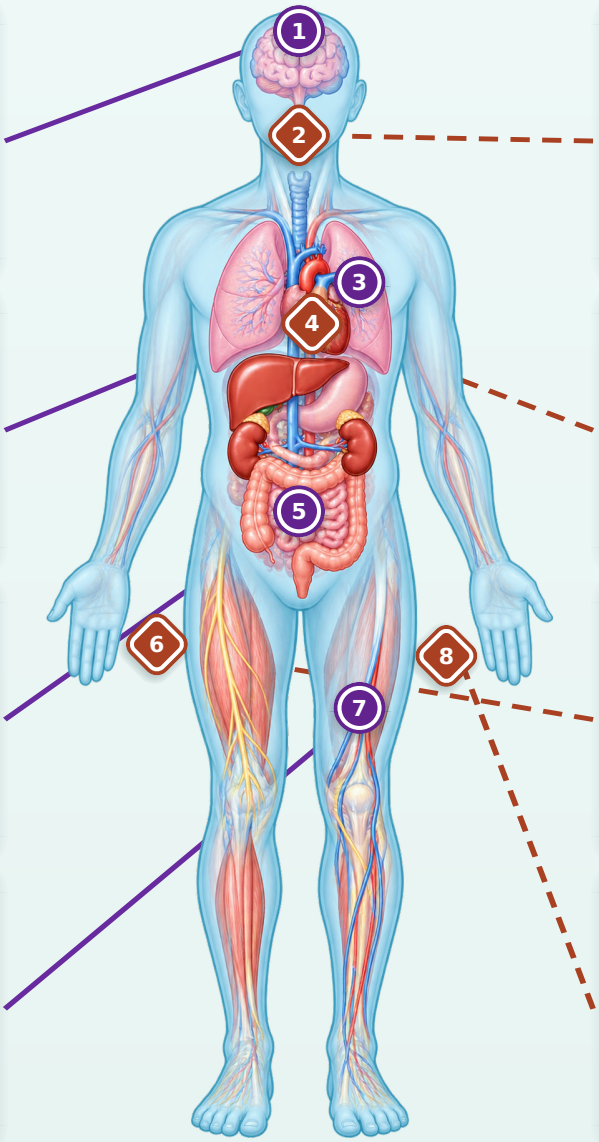
Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

4 Heart

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

New chest pain, fainting or severe breathlessness needs urgent assessment.



5 Bowel

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Report diarrhoea early, especially with poor intake or dizziness.

6 Nerves / joints

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Report numbness, tingling or pain affecting daily activity.

7 Blood / infection

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Fever, shivers, unusual bleeding or sudden illness: call promptly.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Report severe rash, blistering or yellow skin / eyes promptly.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Selected medicine-specific effects; this is not a complete list. Report new or persistent symptoms even after treatment stops.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Doxorubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Blood counts and infection

Fever, shivers or sudden illness needs prompt advice on any day.

Nerve symptoms

Report numbness, tingling or weakness before the next dose.

Support medicines

Follow the prescription for the active medicine and treatment day.

Review the plan

Discuss symptoms, recovery and the next treatment decision with the team.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00485/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.